Great Swamp Bonsai Society

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October, 2005 Newsletter

Next Meeting : 7:00 pm Tuesday, October 11th at the Arboretum.

September Meeting Highlights:

Our September meeting featured a lecture demo by **Roy Nagatoshi** from California. Roy worked on a San Jose Juniper. The tree was quite a challenge, but as you can see, Roy was up to the task. Roy's trees were featured in the ***Karate Kid*** movies of the 1980s and 90s. Roy is currently the president of the California Bonsai Society and has appeared in many venues worldwide. Before the meeting, he conducted a workshop for BYOT enthusiasts.

Here are some highlights of his visit with Great Swamp:

The challenge!

(personally selected)

Work in Progress

And, finally, the end product.

Great job, Roy!

The President's Corner:

Mark Schmuck

Hi folks!

Well another growing season slowly comes to an end.

Tropicals are indoors, at least at night.

This is a good time to make the rounds of garden centers. A lot of places discount trees and shrubs up to 50%. Check out way in the back of some of these places You know, where they dump the shrubs and trees with the broken tops and only a few crooked branches down near the bottom (heh - heh) These items don't usually sell to normal gardeners, so sometimes they'll sell at a reduced price. I've even been told to just take them.

Remember bring a tree or two to every meeting, they usually make for lively discussion.

Dues are due; We had quite a full program of guest artists last season. It costs money to bring them here. And it costs money to supply them with decent tree material. So let's not drag it out , see Fred as soon as you can.

Hope to see you all on Tuesday night,

Mark

Upcoming Events: **(items marked with a ●W denote a workshop)**

October 11: Walter Pall from Germany will be at our meeting along with Jim Doyle from Nature's Way Nursery in Harrisburg, PA. Walter will be working with advanced styling and "tweaking" of members' trees. If you have a tree that you feel needs refinement, be sure to bring it along.

●W **October 12:** Walter Pall at Marty Schmalenberg's Stillwater Studio for Workshop ($50)
Contact Marty at 973.383-8377 to make arrangements and for further details as to time, etc.

November 15: (Another **Third Tuesday** affair, this time due to Election Day, being the first Tuesday following the first Monday of November, and since the month begins on a Tuesday...)
The topic for the meeting will be Over-wintering Trees in Pots.
Discussion, questions and answers. There will also be a short film on the subject...

December 13: Our Annual club auction and Christmas Party!!
Start putting together any bonsai related items for which you no longer have a burning need.
Books, tools, pots, even trees are welcome…
(Just make sure that any live material is protected from possible weather damage.)

NOTE:

Unless otherwise specified, all of the Great Swamp afternoon workshops are held at the Arboretum, in Classroom "A" from 1:00 pm to 4:00 pm., members only, 6 to 8 people, $50 per person, bring your own tree.

And don't forget our website www.arboretumfriends.org/gsbonsai .

Gentle Reminder:

Dues are due. See Fred Aufschläger. He will graciously collect cash or check.
Annual dues remain at: $30.00 for a single membership, or
$40.00 for family membership.

October Plant Care Tips.

Now is the time to sit back and enjoy the changing seasons. Your deciduous material should begin to turn into those beautiful colors of Autumn. Gold, Yellow, Orange and Red should grace your display tables and benches this month. You've earned this respite from the tasks of summer.

Remove any wiring that appears to be digging into your branches. Do this carefully by snipping the wire with an appropriate cutting tool. Be careful not to damage the branches in the process. It's probably not a good idea to attempt re-wiring at this time. Especially if bending of branches would result. Better to wait until spring.

Water only when necessary this month. But be careful to determine the need. Pots can still dry out over the next few months during those occasional warm sunny days. Don't let the morning dew fool you. It can make it look as though the soil is moist. Run your finger into the pot to see if your first impression is good or not. You can also tell by how heavy the pot is...

Remain diligent about removal of debris from the surfaces of your pots. You need to maintain proper hygiene for your trees. Even thought the weather is turning cooler, that leaf litter can still harbor disease that will be difficult to control in the next growing season if it gets a good start now.

Spray trees with an insecticide and fungicide to kill those over-wintering pests and fungus spores.

Keep an eye out for plants to dig up for next year's training. You can take hardwood cuttings and plant hard-shelled collected seeds outdoors. Begin to plan your winter protection....

No more fertilization until next year. If you haven't done so by now, it's probably too late. Resist the urge to feed things until next March.

October is a good time to prune heavy branches on pines, since the sap is no longer freely flowing. Pines that have been pruned in Autumn should be over-wintered in a cool greenhouse or unheated space, protected from the rigors of winter.

- Tips taken from *Growing & Displaying Bonsai* by Colin Lewis and Neil Sutherland and from *Bonsai, the Art of Growing and Keeping Miniature Trees* by Peter Chan

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Ideas and offers of assistance for events, or scheduling questions, can be addressed to any of the officers. Don't be shy. Any and all help would be appreciated.